

SINISTER SQUASHLING

Small Plant (Evil, Cursed)

STATISTICS

Hit Dice: 2d8+3 (12 hp)

Initiative: +2

Speed: 20 ft.

Armor Class: 16 (+1 size, +2 Dex, +3 natural),
touch 13, flat-footed 14

Base Attack/Grapple: +1/+0

Attack: Bite +4 melee (1d6+1)

Full Attack: Bite +4 melee (1d6+1)

Special Attack: Vine Snare, Savage Bite, Pack Entanglement

Space/Reach: 5 ft./5 ft. (vine snare 10 ft.)

Special Qualities: Plant traits, low-light vision, scent,
fire vulnerability

Saves: Fort +4, Ref +2, Will +0

Abilities: Str 12, Dex 15, Con 13, Int 5, Wis 10, Cha 7

Skills: Hide +10, Move Silently +6, Spot +4, Listen +4

Feats: Weapon Finesse

Environment: Cursed fields, cemeteries, overgrown farms

Organization: Solitary, patch (4–12), infestation (20–100+)

Challenge Rating: 1

Treasure: None

Alignment: Neutral Evil

Advancement: 3–4 HD (Small); 5–6 HD (Medium)

Level Adjustment: —



SPECIAL ATTACKS

VINE SNARE (Ex)

A squashling lashes out with a thick vine (10 ft. reach, +4 melee touch).

A hit entangles the target (Str DC 14 or Escape Artist DC 14).

The vine has AC 14 and 5 hp and can be attacked and destroyed.

SAVAGE BITE (Ex)

Squashlings gain a +2 bonus on bite attacks against creatures that are entangled with their vine snare.

PACK ENTANGLEMENT (Ex)

Multiple squashlings can attach vines to the same target. Each additional squashling increases the escape DC by +2 (maximum +6) and grants +1 on opposed Strength checks to drag or trip the target.

DRAW (Ex)

Three or more squashlings attached to the same target may attempt to drag it. Treat the group as one creature with an effective Strength of 16 (3 squashlings), 20 (5 squashlings), or 24 (8+ squashlings). This is often used to pull creatures toward the Gravefield Guardian.

FIRE VULNERABILITY (Ex)

Squashlings take 50% additional damage from fire.

DEATH BURST (Ex)

If a squashling is reduced to 0 hp by fire, electricity, or a critical hit, it bursts apart in a spray of pulp, seeds, and vine fragments. Creatures adjacent to it must succeed on a Reflex save (DC 11) or be covered in sticky, nauseating debris (no damage).

DESCRIPTION

Sinister squashlings are animated gourds of many varieties — pumpkins, acorn squash, zucchini, butternut, and strange, warty growths — brought to grotesque life by the cemetery's curse. Their bodies are little more than hardened rinds filled with seeds, pulp, and writhing vines, animated by a malicious force tied to the Gravefield Guardian. They move in jerky hops and scuttles, using their vine-like tendrils to entangle prey before biting with — surprisingly vicious, seed-lined maws. Individually they are small and easily destroyed, but in great numbers they become a terrifying, relentless threat.

COMBAT

Squashlings rely on surprise, numbers, and entangling vines. They prefer to hide among vegetation, striking distracted targets from behind. Once a victim is entangled, they close in with bites, often working together to drag prey to the Guardian or into the cemetery. They are fearless and take no prisoners, prioritizing spellcasters, injured foes, and restrained creatures.

COMMON VARIETIES



PUMPKIN SQUASHLING
Most common variety.



ACORN SQUASHLING
Tough rind, aggressive.



ZUCCHINI SQUASHLING
Fast and slippery.



BUTTERNUT SQUASHLING
Thick rind, strong vines.



WARTY SQUASHLING
Heavily armored rind.



MIXED GOURD
Unpredictable forms.